



Incident handler's journal

Date: 8/17/2026.	Entry: 001 - Ransomware attack investigation
Description	Analysis and Recovery from a ransomware attack on the organization through phishing emails. However, since they could not work to eradicate and recover from the incident alone, they contacted several other organizations for assistance.
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	• Who: A group of unethical hackers • What: A ransomware attack. • When: Tuesday 9:00 a.m. • Where: At a health care company • Why: The incident happened because unethical hackers were able to access the company's systems using a phishing attack. After gaining access, the attackers launched their ransomware on the company's systems, encrypting critical files. The attackers' motivation appears to be financial because the ransom note they left demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key.
Additional notes	Should the company pay the ransom to retrieve the decryption key? How could the health care company prevent an incident like this from occurring again?

Date: 8/21/2026	Entry: 002 - Malware Analysis
Description	An employee downloaded a malicious spreadsheet that was emailed to him. Upon opening the file, a payload was executed, spreading malware on the computer. The IDS detected and sent out alerts to the SOC.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal
The 5 W's	• Who: An unknown malicious actor • What: An email sent to an employee contained a malicious file attachment with the SHA-256 file hash of 54e6ea47eb04634d3e87fd7787e2136ccfbcc80ade34f246a12cf93bab527f6b • When: at 1:13 p.m. • Where: An employee's computer. • Why; Because the employee downloaded an untrusted and unauthorized email attachment from an unknown person.
Additional notes	Phishing awareness training for employees. Email filtering. Enforces policies against downloading unauthorized files on organizations computers.

Date: 8/21/2020.	Entry: 003 - Phishing incident response
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Description	An alert was investigated about a possible phishing attempt, the phishing email contained a malicious executable file. Alert status was set to “escalated” to notify level-two SOC.
Tool(s) used	IDS, SIEM, Phishing Playbook, VirusTotal
The 5 W's	• Who: Unknown threat actor • What: IDS generated a ticket alert for a possible phishing attempt • When: at 3:14pm • Where: Security Operations Center? • Why: An employee received a suspicious email, and opened an unauthorized spreadsheet containing malware.
Additional notes	Employee trainings, revising escalation policies.

Date: 8/27/28	Entry: 004
Description	Analyzing a packet capture file
Tool(s) used	Wireshark
The 5 W's	• Who: N/A • What: N/A • When: N/A • Where: N/A • Why: N/A

Additional notes	I've never used Wireshark before, so I was excited to begin this exercise and analyze a packet capture file. At first glance, the interface was very overwhelming. I can see why it's such a powerful tool for understanding network traffic.
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Date: 8/27/26.	Entry: 005
Description	Capturing my first packet
Tool(s) used	Tcpdump
The 5 W's	• Who: N/A • What: N/A • When: N/A • Where: N/A • Why: N/A
Additional notes	Using command-line to capture and filter network traffic was a challenge. I got stuck a couple of times because I used the wrong commands. But after carefully following the instructions and redoing some steps, I was able to get through this activity and capture network traffic.
